



**Computer Science Department**

**ETHC 303 Computer Ethics**

**Research Paper 253**

**Activity Description**

This activity is designed to encourage you to explore the dynamic and ever-evolving field of computing ethics, social impact, and sustainability. Your research paper will be an opportunity to explore and critically analyze various ethical and social issues within the realm of computing.

**Weighting:**

This activity constitutes 15% of your overall course grade.

**Group Size:**

Each research project should be undertaken by a group consisting of a minimum of **2** students and a maximum of **3**.

**Submission Deadline:**

You have 2 deadlines:

- Topic Selection & Group Members: **Tuesday, July 14, 2026.**
- Paper & Presentation Submission: **Saturday, July 25, 2026.**

**Topic Selection:**

Each group must choose any of the following topics for your research paper, integrating ethical, social, and sustainability perspectives:

1. Cyber World Ethics - Virtual/Augmented Reality: Examine the ethical considerations surrounding virtual and augmented reality technologies and their impact on society.
2. Cyber World Ethics - Games: Analyze the ethical implications of video games, including issues related to violence, addiction, and virtual economies.
3. Cyber World Ethics - Smart Homes: Investigate the ethical challenges and privacy concerns raised by the integration of smart technologies into our homes.
4. Cyber World Ethics - Smart Cities: Explore the ethical aspects of building and living in smart cities, including issues of surveillance, efficiency, and sustainability.
5. Social Implications of AI and Expert Systems: Discuss the societal impact of artificial intelligence and expert systems in various domains, from healthcare to finance.
6. Social Implications of Data Mining: Analyze the social consequences of data mining, including issues of privacy, discrimination, and data-driven decision-making.
7. Social Implications of Softbots: Examine the ethical and social dimensions of softbots, their role in automation, and their impact on employment and communication.
8. Social Implications of Drones: Investigate the ethical and social concerns surrounding the use of drones in various industries, from military to delivery services.

### **Research Paper Requirements:**

Your research paper should meet the following criteria:

1. **Length**: The paper should be between 8 to 12 pages in length (excluding references), written in 12-point Times New Roman font, double-spaced.
2. **Citations**: You must properly cite your sources using a recognized academic citation style (e.g., APA, MLA, or Chicago).
3. **Abstract**: Include a clear and concise abstract summarizing the key points of your paper.
4. **Introduction**: Provide an introduction to your chosen topic, outlining its relevance and importance.
5. **Literature Review**: Review existing literature related to your chosen topic, summarizing key findings and debates.

6. **Methodology:** Describe the methods and sources used in your research.
7. **Analysis:** Analyze the ethical and social implications of your chosen topic, offering well-reasoned arguments and insights.
8. **Recommendations:** Suggest practical recommendations or solutions to address the issues raised in your paper.
9. **Conclusion:** Summarize the main points of your paper and their significance.
10. **References:** Include a comprehensive list of references to acknowledge the sources you used.

This research paper is an opportunity for you to engage deeply in the ethical and social dimensions of computing, develop critical thinking skills, and make a valuable contribution to this ever-evolving field. Please feel free to reach out if you have any questions or need guidance during your research process.

**Please be mindful that only the group representative is authorized to make the submission, and the submission should consist of two files: the research paper and the PowerPoint presentation.**

## Rubric for Research Paper and Presentation

Research Papers must adhere to the [Ethical and Responsible Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence in Academic and Research Settings](#) (Maximum allowed AI-generated content 30%)

The maximum allowed similarity score is 24%, excluding references ([Turnitin](#))

| Category                          | Scoring Criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Total Max Points |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| <b>Organization</b><br>(4 points) | Technical and Academic Writing Quality                                                                                                                                                                                              | 1                |
|                                   | The paper integrates ethical, social, and sustainability perspectives                                                                                                                                                               | 1                |
|                                   | The <b>length</b> of the paper is appropriate for the topic and audience.                                                                                                                                                           | 1                |
|                                   | <b>Citations</b> are presented as required, and references section includes a comprehensive list of references to acknowledge the sources used.                                                                                     | 1                |
| <b>Content</b><br>(6 points)      | <b>Abstract:</b> A clear and concise summary of the key ethical, social sustainability aspects of the paper.                                                                                                                        | 1                |
|                                   | <b>Introduction:</b> it is an attention-getting, lays out the problem well, and establishes a framework for the rest of the presentation.                                                                                           | 1                |
|                                   | <b>Literature Review:</b> literature is related to the chosen topic, summarizing key findings and sustainability considerations.                                                                                                    | 1                |
|                                   | <b>Methodology:</b> the methods and sources used in the research are described perfectly and the material included is relevant to the overall message/purpose.                                                                      | 1                |
|                                   | <b>Analysis:</b> the ethical and social implications of the chosen topic, offering well-reasoned arguments and insights, and an appropriate amount of material is prepared, and points made reflect well their relative importance. | 1                |

|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |           |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
|                                    | <b>Recommendations and Conclusion:</b> A strong conclusion summarizing the key findings, along with practical and sustainable recommendations for addressing the identified ethical and social challenges. | 1         |
| <b>Presentation<br/>(5 points)</b> | The speaker maintains good eye contact with the audience and is appropriately animated (e.g., gestures, moving around, etc.).                                                                              | 1         |
|                                    | The speaker uses a clear, audible voice, and the delivery is poised, controlled, and smooth                                                                                                                | 1         |
|                                    | Good language skills and pronunciation are used.                                                                                                                                                           | 1         |
|                                    | Visual aids are well prepared, informative, effective, and not distracting.                                                                                                                                | 1         |
|                                    | Length of presentation is within the assigned time limits, and information was well communicated                                                                                                           | 1         |
| <b>Score</b>                       | <b>Total Points</b>                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>15</b> |